European AI Challenge 2026 - Team overview

Team 4 | July 2021 floods (BE / NL / DE) | 29-30 Oct 2026, Brussels | Source: Annexes 1, 3, 4, 5

What we deliver - by Friday 13:30 (Annex 4)

- 1. Policy tool, as a file (html, pptx, png...). We present it in a 5-minute live demo in the second half of Day 2. A blank map template is ready (one HTML file + Android app), with no data in it.
- 2. Policy brief, in the Annex 6 template. 3. AI usage summary sheet, in the Annex 7 template.
- Email all three to JRC-SI@ec.europa.eu and info@fari.brussels.
- The whole team owns all three. Tool and brief must say the same thing to ONE named public actor.

How the jury scores (4 criteria, equal weight)

- Evidence and soundness - can we trust the analysis? Finding backed by the data, uncertainty and limits stated, visuals don't overstate.
- Policy usefulness - could a public actor act on it? Specific, realistic, addressed to a named actor: what, for whom, why.
- Clarity - is it one clear story? A non-specialist can follow; questions get direct answers.
- Responsible AI use - can we explain how we used AI, how we checked it, where it helped and where it fell short?

Roles - 2 people each by default (Annex 5)

- Coders: lead the data analysis for Q1 and Q3; check every result against the challenge data; make the maps, figures and charts. Hand Q1 + Q3 results to the team by the end of Day 1.
- Researchers: lead the desk research for Q2; put the Coders' results in context with public sources; supply evidence for Q4. Deliver Q2 findings with a source list and a note of what could not be verified.
- Communicators: lead Q4 (the recommendation); write the policy brief; shape the policy tool's format, look and key messages; collect everyone's AI notes and compile the AI sheet.
- Everyone: send notes for the AI sheet (key prompts, AI errors caught, checks run).

Day 1 - Thursday 29 Oct - FARI, Cantersteen 16, Brussels

- 09:00 start. Check in (this approves your Claude account in the event organization).
- Opening: the questions Q1-Q4 are revealed. Write them down.
- Split the roles. Agree on one question, one named actor, one story. Start the AI log at the first prompt.
- Proposed scope: Belgium first, Netherlands next, Germany only if time allows (team to confirm).
- Check with a coach that we may use the pre-built empty map template.
- End of Day 1: Coders hand over Q1 + Q3 results; the team presents its draft policy-tool concept to everyone.

Day 2 - Friday 30 Oct - JRC, Rue du Champ de Mars 21, Ixelles

- Bring your ID card (JRC day pass), laptop + charger, phone, power bank.
- Before 11:00: a second Coder recomputes every number in the tool and brief.
- 12:30 freeze | 13:15 send | 13:30 hard deadline. Then the 5-minute live demo.
- Save code outputs + deliverables to gs://outputs_challenge/team-04 (check exact folder name) (opens for uploads only at the end). Keep your own copy: all accounts close at the end of the event.

Getting the data (Annex 1)

- A: Colab Enterprise (easiest). Project "European AI Challenge 2026", region europe-west1, import starter_notebook/how_to_get_started.ipynb, runtime template "hackathon-cpu", Run all.
- B: own Python environment with the starter notebook. C: download all files (~15 GB).
- Always sign in with the event account (...@european-ai-challenge.com), never a personal or university one.

AI rules for everyone (Annex 3)

- No personal data in any prompt (names, emails, phone numbers, photos), of anyone. No passwords, API keys or tokens.
- One team API key with a spending limit: never hard-code it in notebooks or the tool, never paste it into a chat.
- Never upload whole datasets into a chat. Give the AI column names, a few sample rows or the error, then run the code yourself.
- Desk research: AI finds leads, never the source. Open and cite every source (URL + date); drop what you can't verify.
- Tokens last 2 days: default model, a new chat per task, paste only the relevant code. Claude Code uses tokens fastest. Out of tokens: ask a coach.

AI log - from the first hour

- What the AI did, AI errors you caught and how, your 3 best prompts, your checks, and what stays uncertain.

Help

- Account, access or API key problems: the organizing team (Evan, Cedric or Olesya).